



A bony back

The bones inside an animal are known as a skeleton. Fish were the first animals to develop a backbone.

The body of this sea bream is covered in thin scales which overlap like the tiles on a roof.

Fish move their tail, or caudal fin, from side to side to power themselves through the sea.

Fin ray

Anal fin

The dorsal and anal fins stop fish from rolling over in the water.

Fish have a long, thin tube just under the surface of their skin, called a lateral line. It has little lumps of jelly next to it that wobble when the water moves. Fish can feel this—so they know if something is moving near them.

Types of fish

There are three types of fish—those with hard skeletons made of bone, those with skeletons made of rubbery tissue called cartilage, and those that do not have jaws.

Bony fish



Mackerel



Sea horse



Plaice

Cartilaginous fish



Spotted leopard shark

Jawless fish



Lamprey



A lamprey has a sucker instead of a mouth.